NCCA ENTERTAINMENT

PAPER TAGS: Cast Suggestions

Wish list for development discussions. Every name below is a suggestion only. No one has been approached, and availability, interest and pricing are unverified.

Casting strategy: Lifetime and BET+ buyers want recognizable faces with a loyal audience, not just prestige names. Each lead lists a **Top Pick** (the reach), a **Strong Alternate** (more realistic) and a **Wild Card** (a surprise that sharpens the character).

TASHA MONROE

Lead. Homicide detective, mid 30s to early 40s. Controlled, precise, guilt-driven. Plays a woman who turns a ring when she needs the lie to hold.

Top Pick
Meagan Good

Strong Alternate
Tika Sumpter

Wild Card
Nicole Beharie

Why: Needs to carry the whole film. Good plays guarded and wounded; Sumpter brings a strong Lifetime and BET+ fan base; Beharie gives a quieter, more procedural edge.

DRE COLEMAN

Lead. Ex-convict, mechanic and restorer of cars, late 30s. Patient, funny when scared, hiding that he tried and failed to protect Jalen.

Top Pick
Trevante Rhodes

Strong Alternate
Jay Ellis

Wild Card
Sinqua Walls

Why: Needs stillness and warmth with a hint of evasion. Rhodes gives physical quiet, Ellis brings a ready romantic audience, Walls brings humor and weight.

CAPT. RAY DELGADO

Antagonist. APD captain, 50s to 60s. Paternal, institutional, frightening because he is kind. Tasha's mentor.

Top Pick
Giancarlo Esposito

Strong Alternate
Jimmy Smits

Wild Card
Esai Morales

Why: The key is warmth that turns cold in one beat. Esposito is the dream, Smits is the trusted-authority choice, Morales is a strong working option.

S/A ALICIA KELLER

HSI agent, 40s. Operational, direct, unsentimental. Hears Tasha's confession and answers in facts.

Top Pick
Sonja Sohn

Strong Alternate
Gina Torres

Wild Card
Roselyn Sanchez

Why: Needs authority in few words. Sohn has procedural credibility, Torres commands a room, Sanchez adds a distinct federal-agent look.

JALEN MONROE

Tasha's nephew, 17 to 19. Defensive, concrete, grieving his father's craft. Rolls the bar and rams the truck.

Top Pick
Caleb McLaughlin

Strong Alternate
Jaden Michael

Wild Card
Isaiah Russell-Bailey

Why: Must read as scared, not slick. McLaughlin is the draw; Michael and Russell-Bailey are fresh enough to feel like a real kid.

LORRAINE

Malik's mother. Grieving, dignified, asks Tasha one question: "Do you still?"

Top Pick
Loretta Devine

Strong Alternate
Tichina Arnold

Wild Card
Kim Fields

Why: Few scenes, huge impact. Devine for gravity, Arnold for warmth with edge, Fields for a loved, familiar presence.

SUPPORTING ROLES

Roman (the ring's operator, slick and patient, white cuff and gold watch), Teo (the valet shooter, taped glove), Malik Boyd (the opening victim, a young bass player) and the community roles (Ms. Dot, Miss Odessa, Big Ced) are best cast regionally in Atlanta. We recommend open calls through Atlanta casting directors, with Roman and Teo as the key supporting auditions.

PACKAGE NOTES

1. Lock Tasha first. Her attachment sets the rest of the package and the buyer conversation.
2. Pair Tasha and Dre as a unit. Their scenes carry the film's emotional payoff, so a chemistry read is worth doing before offers.
3. Delgado is the highest-leverage supporting cast. A name here can move a development slot by itself.
4. Keep Jalen young and unpolished. Real teenage fear is more valuable than a polished star.

Prepared by NCCA Entertainment. (910) 262-9307 | contact@nccaentertainment.com